

HEALING EVERYWHERE BUT WORK

I thought it was old trauma. *Then everything healed except work.*

How I worked out where the harm was coming from.

I blamed the breakup.

I'd come out of a relationship with a court case attached, and a crowd of my ex's “flying monkeys” keeping it going.

So when I was anxious, I figured that was the leftover. I did the work: boundaries, rest, rebuilding my people.

And it worked. Almost everywhere.

Where I felt safe, over time



This is my own rough picture, not data. Try drawing yours. If one bar won't move however much you heal, pay attention to that bar.

CHECKLIST

Signs the harm is coming from the room, not from you

1. You feel better on days off, and the dread comes back the night before a shift.
2. You rehearse your defense before conversations that haven't happened yet.
3. The rules seem stricter for you than for everyone else.
4. Your memory gets questioned more at work than anywhere else in your life.
5. You've started writing things down that you never needed to before.
6. People repeat a story about you that you've never heard firsthand.

RESEARCH NOTE

It's not only the bully. It's what happens after you speak up.

Psychologists Carly Smith and Jennifer Freyd call it **institutional betrayal**: when an organization responds badly to a report of harm, the bad response adds a second injury on top of the first.

So if reporting made it worse, you aren't overreacting. That second injury has been documented.

Source: Smith & Freyd (2014), *American Psychologist*

Stop asking “what's wrong with me?”

Start asking “what's happening to me?”

This isn't a diagnosis. If you're in crisis in the US, call or text 988.



ON SUBSTACK NOW

Part 1: Healing Everywhere But Work

How I separated old wounds from new ones, and what my records showed me.

Link in bio.